

TRUCK BUILDER

The Truck Builder Overland Gear Checklist

You've got the platform every gear manufacturer designs for. This checklist covers the essential gear for a capable, trail-ready truck build — from recovery to camp systems. Priority column: 1 = do first, 2 = next season, 3 = nice-to-have.

RECOVERY & SAFETY

■	MaxTrax MKII Recovery Boards (pair) Most versatile recovery tool for trucks. Doubles as a shovel platform. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-recovery-gear.html	Priority 1
■	WARN VR EVO 10-S Winch Best value winch for 1/2-ton trucks. 10,000 lb rated, synthetic rope. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-winch.html	Priority 1
■	Kinetic Recovery Rope (3/4" × 20 ft) Stretches to absorb shock — safer and more effective than static straps. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-recovery-gear.html	Priority 1
■	Hi-Lift Jack (60") Essential for trucks. Doubles as a come-along in a pinch. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-hi-lift-jack-alternatives.html	Priority 1
■	Overlanding First Aid Kit (IFAK-level) Carry a kit rated for remote, multi-day use. Not a basic car kit. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-first-aid-kit-essentials.html	Priority 1
■	Tow Hooks / D-Ring Mounts (front+rear) Factory hooks are often inadequate. Add rated D-ring mounts.	Priority 1
■	Tire Repair Kit + CO2 Inflator Plug kit + portable compressor. Fix a flat on the trail, not on the side of the highway.	Priority 1
■	Fire Extinguisher (2.5 lb ABC) Mount within reach of driver. Check annually.	Priority 1

BED & STORAGE

■	Bed Rack System (Leitner, Prinsu, etc.) Enables rooftop tent, solar, and gear mounting without losing bed access.	Priority 1
■	Drawer / Slide System (Decked, ARB) Organizes gear, protects equipment, and keeps the bed usable.	Priority 2
■	Pelican / Nanuk Hard Cases For cameras, electronics, and anything that can't get wet.	Priority 2
■	Cargo Net or Tie-Down Straps Secure loose gear on rough trails.	Priority 1
■	Fuel Caddy / Jerry Can (5 gal) NATO-style steel or rotopax. Adds 70–100 miles of range. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-diesel-vs-gasoline-for-overlanding.html	Priority 2

POWER & REFRIGERATION

■	Dometic CFX3 55 Fridge / Freezer Best-in-class for trucks. Runs on 12V/24V, holds temp in 100°F ambient. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-fridges.html	Priority 1
■	Dual Battery System (AGM or Lithium) Isolator + secondary battery protects starting battery. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html	Priority 1
■	Renogy 200W Flexible Solar Kit Mounts flat on bed rack. Keeps battery topped off at camp. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html	Priority 2
■	12V Power Distribution Block Fused block for fridge, lights, and accessories.	Priority 1

LIGHTING

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| ■ | Baja Designs Squadron Pro (pair)
Best pod lights for trucks. Spot/combo beam. 5-year warranty.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-off-road-light-bars.html | Priority 2 |
| ■ | Rigid Industries 30" Light Bar
Roof or bed-rack mount. 150,000+ hour LED lifespan.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-off-road-light-bars.html | Priority 2 |
| ■ | Amber Fog/Dust Lights
Amber cuts through dust better than white. Essential for desert running. | Priority 3 |

SLEEPING & CAMP

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| ■ | Rooftop Tent (iKamper, CVT, Smittybilt)
Mounts to bed rack. Setup in 60 seconds. Keeps you off the ground.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/rooftop-tent-buying-guide.html | Priority 2 |
| ■ | Camp Kitchen (Coleman, GSI, Camp Chef)
2-burner propane stove + cookware set. Non-negotiable for multi-day trips. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Water Storage (5–10 gal rigid jug)
Rigid jugs > soft bags for trucks. Mount in bed or on rack.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Water Filter (Sawyer Squeeze or MSR)
Backup to stored water. Essential for remote travel.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html | Priority 1 |

NAVIGATION & COMMUNICATION

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| ■ | Garmin inReach Mini 2
Satellite communicator. Two-way messaging anywhere on Earth.
Non-negotiable for solo trips.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Garmin Overlander GPS
Purpose-built overlanding GPS with topo maps and track recording. | Priority 2 |
| ■ | Onx Offroad App (annual subscription)
Best digital map app. Shows land ownership, trails, and campsites. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | GMRS Radio (Midland MXT275)
Longer range than FRS. Requires FCC license (easy, \$35, 10-year term).
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html | Priority 2 |